

and then converts the JavaScript into code that will allow you to build iPhone, Android, and Windows Desktop applications. The downside to using intermediate technologies is that you are dependent on the development company to update their tools to the latest SDKs and technologies. This can be hard work as the SDKs are frequently updated. For instance, Apple has updated its iOS operating system five times in three years, and Google's Android has been updated five times in less than two years.

With all that said, it is much easier to develop using intermediate languages. You can leverage skills you already have without having to go through the learning curve of adopting a new language. Adobe has been making major leaps in developing such intermediate packages through its Flex framework. Since last summer Adobe has brought both the Flash Player and AIR (Adobe Integrated Runtime) to Google's Android. This is really big for several reasons,

- ▶ The version of Flash coming to the Android is the latest version 10 and above, not some crippled alternative.
- ▶ AIR gives you an immediate in-road into mobile device development, leveraging the tools and knowledge many might already have.
- ▶ Android runs on tablets and TVs as well as phones. The Flash Player that is now available for users of Android 2.2 and above.

There has been a lot of noise from companies such as Apple stating that Flash is a battery hog and will kill your phone's CPU. Is this true? The reality is that it is not. Tests have been conducted showing that the Flash Player on mobile devices is highly efficient and does not cause the CPU crippling results Apple is stating. The Flash Player works inside the browser in Android. You trigger the use of the Flash Player by tapping on the Flash content in the web page. For instance, you can view a Hulu.com video by tapping on the content in the page.

Flash support for mobile devices is being released by Adobe for over 20 different mobile development companies. What does this mean for you? This basically provides the user the ability to learn just one basic workflow and be able to develop for not just Android but for other platforms which have adopted Adobe's technologies like RIM's BlackBerry, Nokia, HP/Palm WebOS, and Microsoft's Windows Phones 7. The Flash Player as the plugin is also available for systems like Google TV and BlackBerry Tablet OS, LiMo and Samsung SmartTVs .